International Justice and Peace

GS II

- International law establishes rules governing relations between countries and the protection of people during conflicts. **International humanitarian law** seeks to limit suffering during warfare, while international criminal law provides mechanisms for holding individuals responsible for certain serious international crimes.

- International courts and tribunals investigate or adjudicate grave violations such as genocide, war crimes and crimes against humanity within their respective jurisdictions. Their work reinforces the principle that political authority or official position should not automatically protect individuals from **legal accountability**.

- International justice faces difficulties because courts often depend on **cooperation from countries** to obtain evidence, arrest suspects and enforce decisions. Political resistance and selective cooperation can weaken accountability, particularly when powerful governments or influential political figures are involved.

- Peace agreements may stop immediate violence, but **lasting reconciliation** also requires addressing past abuses and protecting victims' rights. Independent investigations, fair legal proceedings and respect for international institutions can help prevent impunity and strengthen confidence in peaceful conflict resolution.

Lasting peace requires more than ending violence. International legal accountability, protection of victims and cooperation with judicial institutions help build a rules-based global order.